



Introduction

Having a new baby is the most exciting time and often prompts the desire to hand-make gorgeous gifts. *Made for Baby* shows you how to make beautiful clothing and toys for baby, accessories for the nursery, and keepsakes for mum that are sure to be cherished for many years.

This book contains more than 50 project ideas to inspire you. You can follow the steps closely, or use the general techniques to create your own projects. For example, try changing the shape of the ears and tail on the Floppy mouse toy (see pages 136–143) to make him into a rabbit; create your own stencil, stamp, or embroidery designs; or transform a simple hand drawing into a piece of appliqué or button art using the step-by-step techniques. Use your creativity to make each project your very own.

It is usually best to pre-wash and pre-shrink all fabrics for any project before cutting or sewing so when you wash the item in the future the fabrics will not shrink and distort your creation. Always be safety conscious when making anything for a baby or child and ensure that all pieces, especially buttons, are securely attached. Regularly check any handmade projects for wear and tear and repair them if necessary. Now all you have to do is turn the page to find the perfect gift for your special baby.

